

Tim Brackney & Anthony Laria / Springline Advisory — Meeting Prep

Date: June 16, 2026 | 3:00–3:30 PM CT **Format:** Microsoft Teams **Improving attendees:** David O'Hara, Devlin Liles **Springline attendees:** Tim Brackney (CEO), Anthony Laria (Head of Integration)

Background / History

Tim Brackney — CEO, Springline Advisory

25+ years in professional services. Built his career at the top of the industry before going the PE-backed platform route:

- **PwC** — 7 years, Senior Manager
- **RGP (Resources Connection)** — 22 years, rising to **President & COO** of a publicly traded professional services firm (~\$700M revenue at its peak). This is the defining credential — he ran a large, complex services operation and knows what good looks like.
- **Springline Advisory** — CEO since launch (Jan 2024). His mandate: build the platform.

Tim is not a first-time CEO or an accountant who got promoted. He's an experienced operator who chose to lead a PE-backed roll-up in the accounting/advisory space. He thinks in scale, integration, and platform economics.

Origin of this relationship: Davis Fox (VP, Trinity Hunt Partners — the PE backer) introduced Tim to Devlin Liles in April 2026, specifically because Springline was looking for an AI consulting partner. Devlin has been running the conversation. Tim asked to loop David in. The June 16 call was rescheduled from an earlier date at Tim's request.

Anthony Laria — Head of Integration, Springline Advisory

His title is Head of Integration — not COO. That's a meaningful distinction: he owns how acquired firms get absorbed into the Springline platform. He's the person who has to execute whatever AI engagement Improving proposes. Prior background includes PwC and his own consulting firm (Laria Enterprises). He'll be the operational voice in the room — focused on what's actually buildable, what the firms they've acquired can absorb, and what the integration timeline looks like.

Anthony being on this call is a signal. Tim doesn't bring his Head of Integration to a relationship call — he brings him when he's ready to get into implementation logistics. Treat Anthony's presence as confirmation that Tim intends to move.

What Tim said in the thread (June 1 email): "I'd like to lock down my plan in the next two weeks." That was June 1 — he's past that window now. The urgency is real.

Company Overview

Springline Advisory — Addison, TX (HQ)

PE-backed accounting and advisory roll-up launched January 2024. Trinity Hunt Partners (Dallas-based PE) is the backer. The model: acquire established regional CPA and advisory firms, integrate them under one brand and operating platform, and grow through a combination of organic expansion and continued M&A.

Scale as of 2026:

- ~770+ employees across 14 offices
- \$165M+ estimated revenue
- 9+ firms acquired since launch
- Ranked 6th fastest-growing accounting firm in 2026
- 84.2% revenue growth in 2025

Founding firm: HM&M Advisory (Dallas) — a well-regarded DFW accounting and advisory firm that became the platform anchor.

Strategic context: Springline explicitly came looking for an AI consulting partner through their PE network (Trinity Hunt → Davis Fox → Devlin). They didn't stumble into this — they identified AI enablement as a strategic priority and went looking for the right firm.

The integration challenge as AI opportunity: Every acquired firm brings its own workflows, tools, culture, and resistance to change. Springline needs to normalize operations across 14 offices and 770+ professionals while continuing to acquire. AI-assisted workflow standardization, knowledge capture, and enablement is how they scale without chaos.

Improving's Position

This is a deal-advancement meeting, not discovery. Devlin sent a draft SOW and MSA on June 1. Tim's response the same day: "I'd like to lock down my plan in the next two weeks." The call exists to advance toward signature.

David's role: Executive alignment and strategic framing. Tim ran a \$700M public company. He'll want to know he's talking to a peer on the Improving side who understands the platform challenge. David's job is to establish that peer relationship, reinforce confidence in the engagement, and help Tim get comfortable committing.

Devlin's role: Technical and delivery lead. He owns the scope. David defers to Devlin on proposal specifics.

Why Improving for Springline:

- AI practice with real enterprise delivery experience
- Devlin's credibility as Chief AI & Consulting Officer — active practitioner, not a slide-deck seller
- Experience with change management at scale — 770 professionals across 14 acquired firms is an organizational transformation challenge
- Dallas-based with presence in Springline's markets
- Trinity Hunt already trusts the referral

Competitive considerations: Unknown who else Springline is talking to. The Trinity Hunt intro suggests Improving was specifically recommended. Don't assume exclusivity, but don't act like you're fighting for position.

Proposed Agenda

30 minutes. Goal: leave with a verbal yes on the SOW or a clear list of what needs to change before Tim signs. Do not end without a defined next step and a date.

- **0:00–0:03** Welcome / brief intros (acknowledge Anthony — he's new to the conversation)
- **0:03–0:10** Tim's current context — let him frame where Springline is right now, what's pressing, what he's solving in the next 90 days

- **0:10–0:20** Walk the draft proposal — Devlin leads on scope and deliverables; David anchors the strategic framing
 - **0:20–0:27** Tim and Anthony's questions and objections — give them room; Anthony will have operational questions about what the integration timeline can absorb
 - **0:27–0:30** Next steps — explicit: what's needed before SOW goes final, who owns it, and when
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Talking Points

1. Springline's growth creates a narrow window for this kind of work. At 84% growth and 9+ acquisitions, the next 12–18 months either solidify the platform or create compounding fragmentation. AI enablement is most effective when introduced *during* integration — not after the culture and workflows have calcified across 14 offices.

2. This is a workforce adoption challenge, not a tooling project. What Improving brings isn't a list of AI tools to deploy — it's experience getting 500+ professionals who didn't ask for change to actually change how they work. That's harder than the technology, and it's where most firms stall.

3. Devlin is the engagement lead — not a hand-off. Tim should hear from David directly that Devlin owns delivery. Improving doesn't pitch senior people and hand off to a junior team. What he's been talking to is what he gets.

4. Trinity Hunt backed this introduction for a reason. Davis Fox doesn't refer vendors casually. If the PE network is routing this to Improving, it's because they've seen results at portfolio companies. That framing reframes the conversation from vendor evaluation to trusted referral.

5. Ask Anthony directly about the integration calendar. The Head of Integration is in this call because Tim is getting ready to move. Ask Anthony: what does the integration calendar look like for the next two quarters, and where does AI enablement have to fit? His answer shapes the SOW as much as Tim's priorities do.